Retell: The Starfish

Day 3 · Retell

What to do: Student A retells steps 1–4, student B steps 5–8. Then swap the roles.

In the book
4000 Essential English Words 1, Unit 9, **"The Starfish"**, page 60 (the story) · page 61 (questions).
Read it once (5 minutes), close the book, then retell with the map below.

#	Say	Words to use
1	Where did the writer go last summer?	island · trip · fun · waves
2	What did he do there?	watch · listen · identify · discover · taste
3	What happened one evening?	walk · ocean · waves · starfish · beach
4	Why was he sad?	sand · die · water · damage · fix
5	Who did he see?	little girl · sad · prevent
6	What did the writer say? How did the girl feel?	frank · nothing · cry · emotion
7	What did the girl do?	rock · stand up · throw · save
8	What was her answer?	cannot save all · save this one · smile

★ Ask and answer: How long…? (add to your retelling)

1. How long has the girl been on the beach? How long has the writer been there? (evening · walk)
2. How long have the starfish been on the sand? (waves · die)
3. How long have you known a place like this? (beach · island)

Three ways to retell

Day 3 · Retell

What to do: Rounds 1 to 3 take about 15 minutes. Then the speaking questions.

1 Round 1: with the story map

Retell the whole story to your partner. The listener ticks the words they hear.

- [ ] against
- [ ] beach
- [ ] damage
- [ ] discover
- [ ] emotion
- [ ] fix
- [ ] frank
- [ ] identify
- [ ] island
- [ ] ocean
- [ ] perhaps
- [ ] pleasant
- [ ] prevent
- [ ] rock
- [ ] save
- [ ] step
- [ ] still
- [ ] taste
- [ ] throw
- [ ] wave

2 Round 2: change the narrator

Retell it as **the writer**, **the girl** or **a starfish**. Use "I": *"I have been on this beach for an hour, and I..."*

3 Round 3: change the ending

The writer helps the girl. What happens the next morning? Invent a new ending (3–4 sentences).

4 Listener's check

- [ ] 5+ Unit 9 words
- [ ] for / since in the questions, past simple for the story
- [ ] a clear order
- [ ] one new idea

5 Warm-up: irregular verbs, the 3rd form, set 3 (say the 3rd form)

sing	steal	throw	wake
choose	fly	grow	show
draw	freeze		

sung · stolen · thrown · woken · chosen · flown · grown · shown · drawn · frozen